Whitney Museum

Mrs. Harry Payne Whitney (Gertrude Vanderbilt), sculptor and art patron, has announced that next autumn she will found the Whitney Museum of American Art at 8 West Eighth St., formerly her studio and now the Whitney Galleries, and the house next door, at No. 10, which until this year was the Whitney Studio Club. During the summer the buildings will be remodeled into nine galleries, to show 400 paintings. Then a permanent museum will be planned at a location to be selected.

New artists will be encouraged and their works bought. Books and other material will be published, and a bureau of information started.

"At the present time there is no museum in America devoted exclusively to the American fine arts, and it is in part to fill this amazing gap in the ever-growing lists of American museums that Mrs. Whitney has founded a museum of American art," said the announcement.

"Ever since museums were invented contemporary liberal artists have had difficulty in 'crashing the gate.' Museums have had the habit of waiting until a painter or a sculptor had acquired a certain official recognition before they would accept his work within their sacred portals. Exactly the contrary practice will be carried on in the Whitney Museum of American Art."

Print Show Awards

The following prizes were awarded at the international lithograph and wood engraving exhibition at the Chicago Art Institute: Logan first prize ($100), John Copley's "Alassio—Starry Night"; second ($75), Thomas W. Nason's "Willow Tree and Cottage"; third ($50), S. Jessurun de Mesquita's "Water Goat"; Brewster lithography prize ($50), Louis Lozowick's "Still Life"; Brewster wood engraving prize ($50), Agnes Miller Parker's "Sheep Dipping in Wales."

Will Make Buffalo Panels

To Albert Stewart, young sculptor, has been awarded the decoration of the Buffalo City Hall, comprising three panels, each 100 feet long, depicting modern Buffalo and the city 100 years ago.

"Colours the Masters Use"

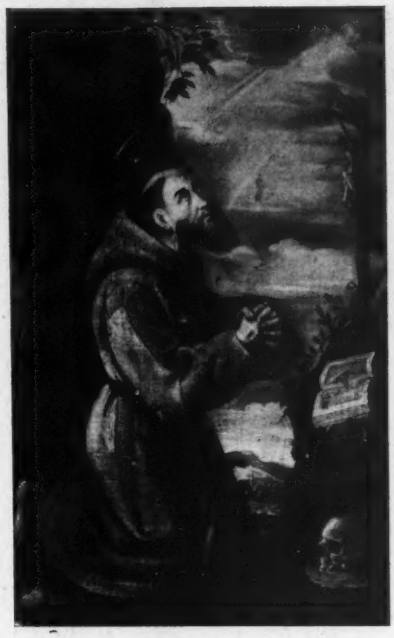


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$7.50 "Old Master" May Be An El Greco



"St. Francis." Attributed to El Greco.

The bane of the art writer's existence, and of the museum official's also, is the man or woman who discovers an "old master." It has been said that every street car motorman has written a play. Very likely it is true, but every preacher, cook, taxi driver and doctor has at one time or another found a "priceless" old master and summoned a critic or a museum official to tell him how many tens of thousands it was worth. Not more than once or twice in a lifetime is such a picture of any value, but it is the fact that a pearl may somehow exist in a mountain of oysters that keeps the victim from instantly slaying the said professional man or toiler, and throwing himself on the mercy of the court.

It looks as if such a miracle happened when Clark Johnson, a San Francisco resident, took what he thought was an old picture of a Persian rajah to George Barron, curator of the De Young Museum. Mr. Johnson had been attracted by the picture in the window of a second-hand store and had paid $7.50 for it. In trying to clean the picture with soap and water he used too much soap and the rajah began to curl up and come off, so he went to Mr. Barron for help.

The curator, after looking at the old painting, went to work with a solvent on one corner of it. Out rolled a skull. With the owner's consent he kept on and there was gradually disclosed a fine old Spanish picture of St. Francis of Assisi, San Francisco's patron saint. Mr. Barron murmured "El Greco." He called in all the local authorities he could find and they "unanimously agreed that El Greco painted the entire picture." Among them was Louis Boisserée, locally known connoisseur and collector; Prof. Lorenzo Capatini of the Vatican Gallery, who happened to be in San Francisco; Prof. L. L. Gluck and Arthur Braud, the Spanish vice-consul. If the authenticity is finally established by the world's big experts, it will probably be bought by the De Young Museum.

Mr. Johnson was sorry to lose his Persian rajah, who was on dress parade and looked very magnificent, but he has become reconciled to the possession of an "El Greco" that may be worth $50,000 or more.

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